

Viber database hacked

Syrian Electronic Army has hacked Viber. The message: "Dear All Viber Users, the Israeli-based 'Viber' is spying and tracking you" has since been taken down

Another Facebook annoyance

Facebook now wants to know why you're hiding a particular photo, news item or ad from your friends to better understand its users and serve them relevant ads



This month we highlight some aspiring tech writers and their spirited attempt to get published in the magazine. Let's have more!

Readers' reviews

Paranoid Android



Isban Verma

Paranoid Android ROM is maintained and created by a highly motivated group of people. Only certain numbers of mobiles are currently supported by the developers, but the unofficial ports can

be found on the XDA forum. This ROM packs lots of awesome features which can completely transform your mobile's usability and interface. The developers are working hard to bring still more features to the ROM as well as to extend the list of officially supported devices.

The hybrid engine

The popularity of this ROM can be accounted to its hybrid engine which allows you access to a user interface which fuses together elements of the Android tablet and phone UIs, so you can have the tablet-style notifications bar on

your handset. The hybrid engine allows you to target apps individually. You get to pick their actual layouts which can transform content drastically. It doesn't matter if your device runs itself using a phone, phablet or tablet UI, your apps will always look as you like.

Over the years, the ROM has gotten a lot of changes but the hybrid engine has remained the same. In current Paranoid Android ROM 3+ the developers have introduced features like 'Pie mode' and 'Halo'.

Pie mode

This mode is particularly beneficial to users with software navigation buttons à la Nexus 4. When in expanded mode (better known as Pie Mode), users can clear all the recent applications and quickly flow through your device with just a finger-swipe. This mode can be activated by pressing the power button. It removes the status bar and the navigation bar from the bottom, thus freeing up more space on the screen. Pie mode creates a compact semi-circle on which different options are embedded. These options can be accessed by swiping in specific directions. Pie mode can also be set to automatic, so when a particular app is opened the pie mode is triggered automatically.

Halo

Halo is the latest feature implemented in Paranoid Android. This feature is influenced by the newly popular Facebook chat heads. The developers have cleverly modified the chat heads to show the notifications for every app, but this is just a part of the whole story. Halo takes multitasking to a whole new level. You can use it in full screen as well as minimized mode.

Per-app-color

Paranoid Android's coolest invention. Define apps in your regular hybrid panel.

See your phone fade into the colour definition of your current app. Press home or go elsewhere and it fades back. Create as many combinations you like. You can even dabble with opacity. This feature is made possible by hybrid engine.

For all who want more control over their system, Paranoid Android is definitely worth a look. However it's also at the moment not to everyone's taste. That's the most important thing for me about Android – choice. There are other platforms out there that don't give you that much freedom and such features would be completely impossible.

iBall PF1209

The PF1209 comes with a pen, a holder, a wireless mouse, a few pen tips and 2 x AAA batteries. The software bundled along are Adobe Photoshop CS3 Extended, Corel Painter Essential 2, Corel Painter X and Photo Album, all for a 30-day trial.



Dileep Mohanan

The pen

The pen has a removable plastic tip and two buttons on its barrel which can be software programmed to perform any of the following functions – left click, left double-click, middle click, middle double-click, right click, right double-click or no action at all.

The tablet

The tablet can be fixed in a slight slant using two flaps that comes along with it. There's an LED that indicates whether the pen's touch is detected by the tablet. The USB cable on the tablet is non-detachable. There are no hardware keys, but not to worry, there's a whopping array of 20

